Online Retail Store

Executive Insights Report

Prepared for: **CEO & CMO** | Data Period: Dec 2010 – Dec 2011 | April 2026

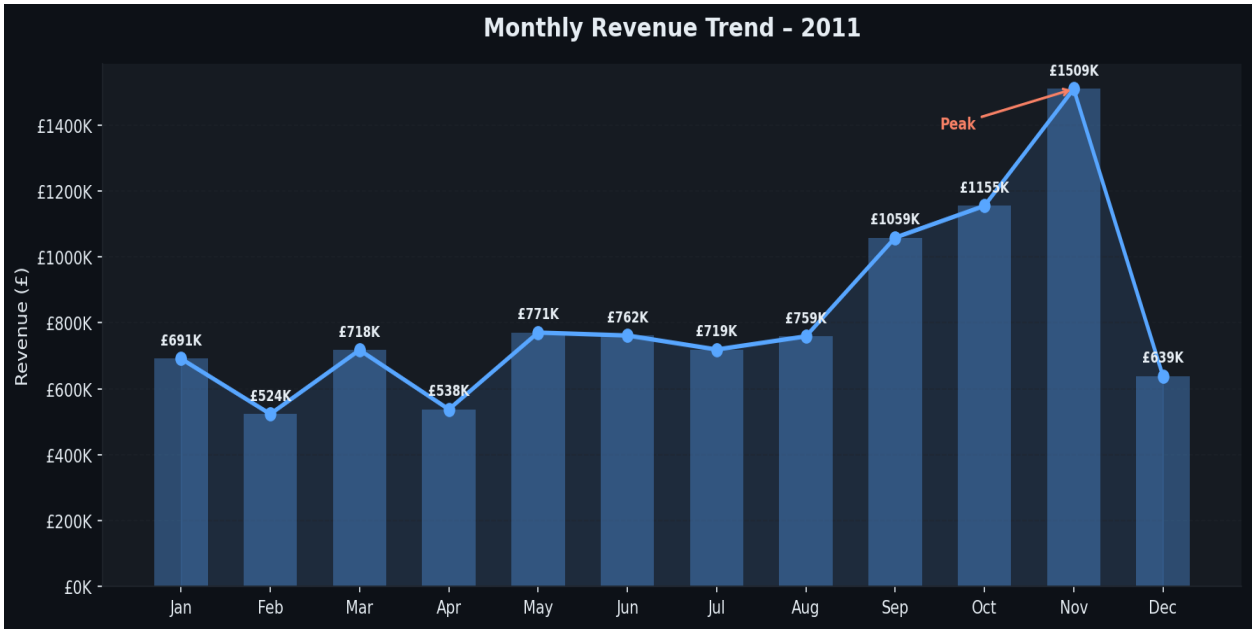
£10.67M	19,960	4,338	38
Total Revenue	Total Invoices	Unique Customers	Countries Served

This report presents a data-driven analysis of the online retail store's performance across four strategic dimensions requested by the CEO and CMO. The dataset was first cleaned to remove returns (negative quantities) and erroneous unit prices below £0, ensuring analytical integrity. Insights are structured to support the company's international expansion strategy.

Contents:

1. Monthly Revenue Time Series (2011) — Page 2
2. Top 10 Countries by Revenue & Quantity — Page 3
3. Top 10 Customers by Revenue — Page 4
4. Global Product Demand (Expansion Map) — Page 5
5. Strategic Recommendations — Page 6

Question 1 — Monthly Revenue Time Series (2011)



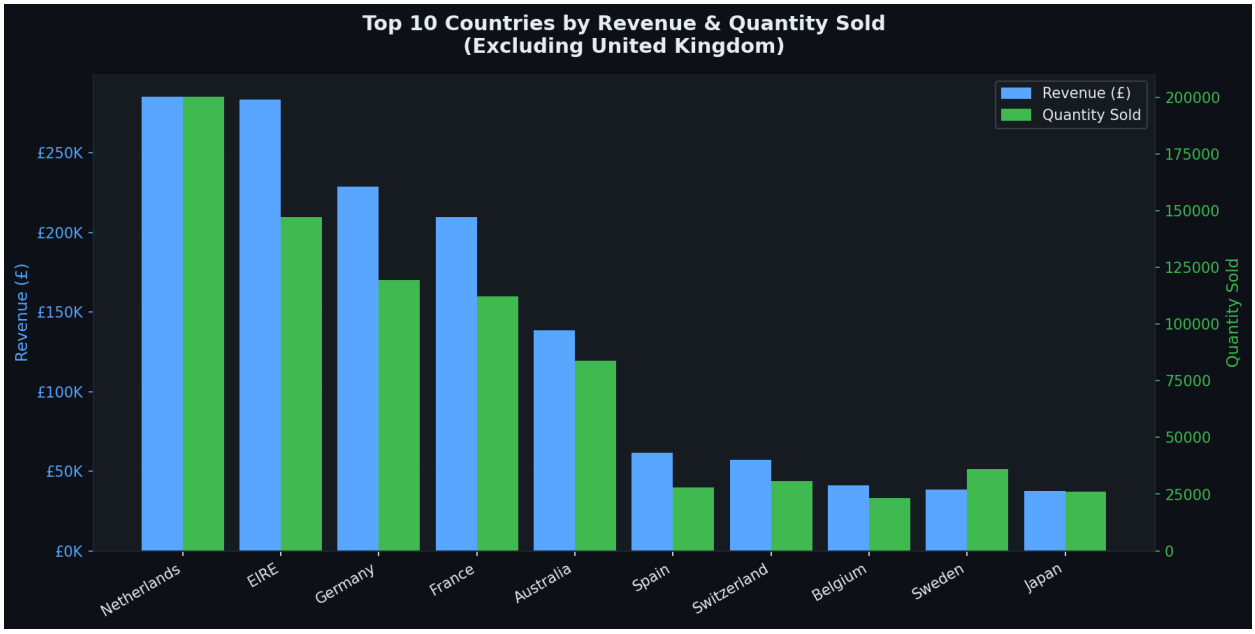
Key Findings:

The monthly revenue chart for 2011 reveals a clear seasonal pattern across the year. Revenue remained relatively stable in the first half, averaging around £500K–£600K per month. A notable surge begins from **September onwards**, reaching a **peak in Nov** with **£1509K** in revenue. This spike is strongly linked to the Christmas and holiday shopping season, as customers typically purchase gifts and seasonal goods in bulk during Q4.

Month	Revenue
Jan	£691.4K
Feb	£523.6K
Mar	£717.6K
Apr	£537.8K
May	£770.5K
Jun	£761.7K
Jul	£719.2K
Aug	£759.1K
Sep	£1058.6K
Oct	£1155.0K
Nov	£1509.5K
Dec	£638.8K

Strategic Insight: The CEO should plan **inventory build-up and marketing pushes** from August–September to capitalise on the Q4 demand surge. Forecasting models for 2012 should anticipate approximately 3–4× the average monthly revenue during November–December.

Question 2 — Top 10 Countries by Revenue & Quantity (Excl. UK)



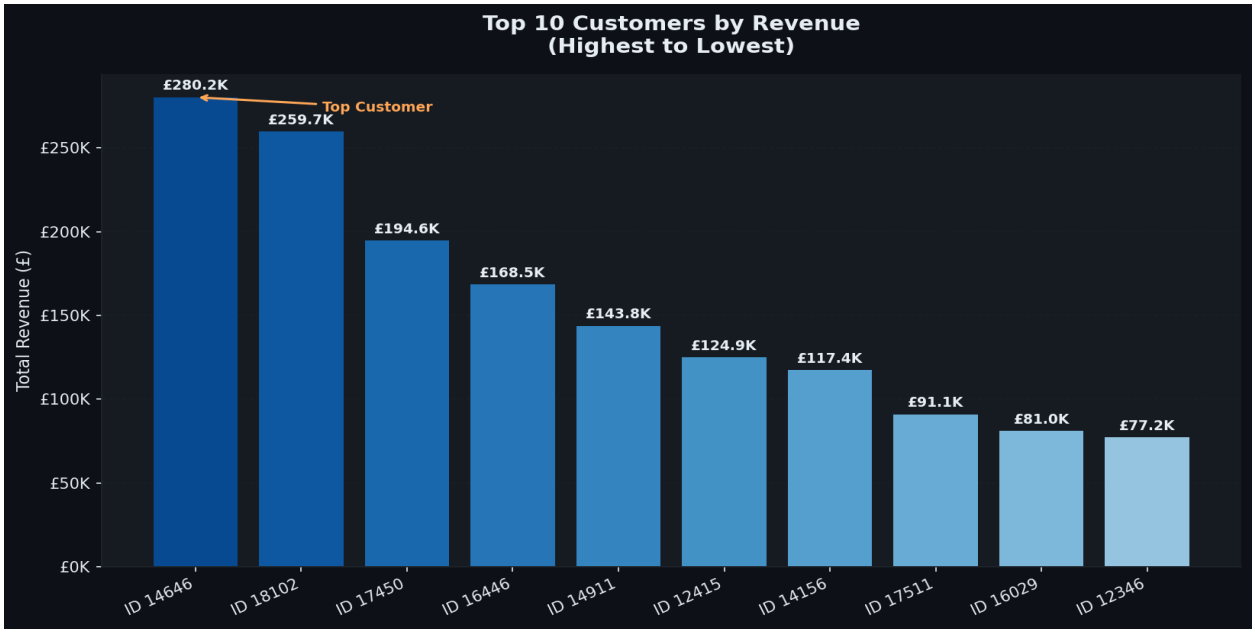
Key Findings:

Excluding the home market (United Kingdom), **Netherlands** emerges as the top revenue-generating country with **£285K**. The Netherlands and EIRE (Ireland) also feature prominently. Interestingly, some countries generate high revenue despite lower unit quantities, suggesting higher average order values — a signal of premium purchasing behaviour.

Rank	Country	Revenue (£)	Quantity Sold
1	Netherlands	£285,446	200,361.0
2	EIRE	£283,454	147,173.0
3	Germany	£228,867	119,261.0
4	France	£209,715	112,103.0
5	Australia	£138,521	83,901.0
6	Spain	£61,577	27,940.0
7	Switzerland	£57,090	30,629.0
8	Belgium	£41,196	23,237.0
9	Sweden	£38,378	36,083.0
10	Japan	£37,416	26,016.0

Strategic Insight: The CMO should prioritise **targeted marketing campaigns** in Netherlands, Netherlands, and Germany, as these are the highest-value non-UK markets. Countries with high quantity but lower revenue may benefit from upselling strategies to increase average basket value.

Question 3 — Top 10 Customers by Revenue



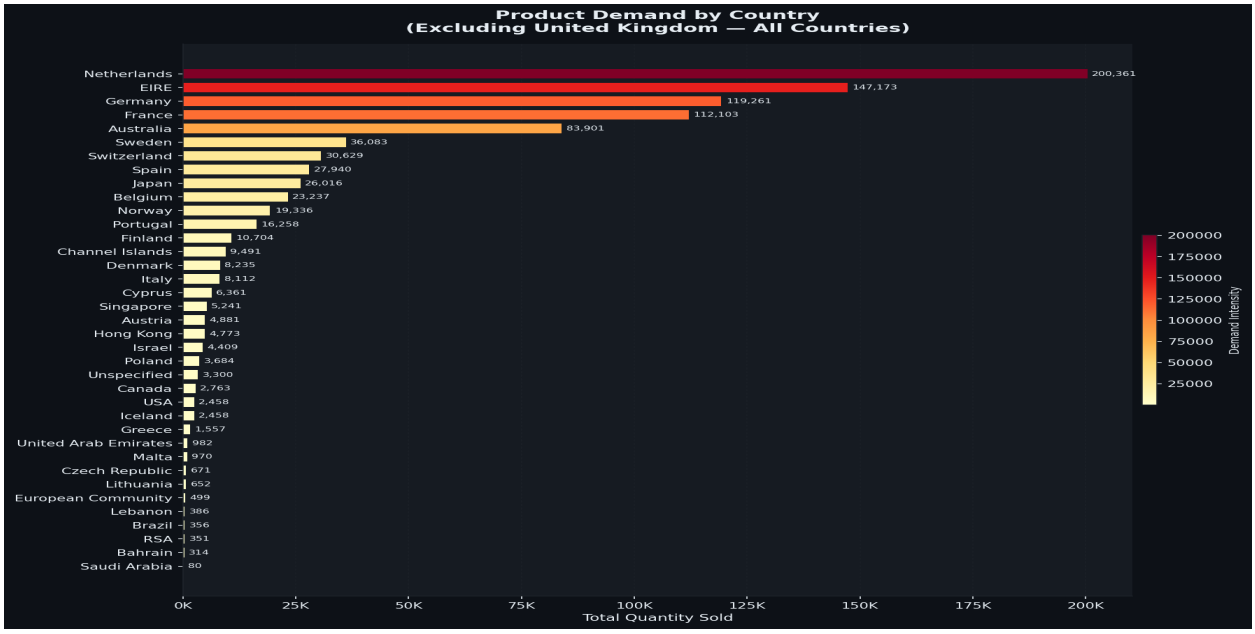
Key Findings:

Customer **ID 14646** is the single highest revenue-generating customer with **£280.2K** in total purchases — significantly ahead of the second-ranked customer. The chart displays a **declining staircase pattern**, with a steep drop-off after the top 3 customers. This concentration suggests that a small group of customers drive a disproportionate share of revenue, a classic Pareto (80/20) dynamic.

Rank	Customer ID	Revenue (£)
1	ID 14646	£280,206
2	ID 18102	£259,657
3	ID 17450	£194,551
4	ID 16446	£168,472
5	ID 14911	£143,825
6	ID 12415	£124,915
7	ID 14156	£117,380
8	ID 17511	£91,062
9	ID 16029	£81,025
10	ID 12346	£77,184

Strategic Insight: The CMO should implement a **VIP loyalty programme** targeting the top 10 customers. Personalised communication, early access to new products, and exclusive discounts will strengthen retention. A customer success manager should be assigned to Customer ID 14646 given their outsised revenue contribution.

Question 4 — Global Product Demand by Country (Excl. UK)



Key Findings:

The demand heatmap provides a single-view snapshot of product demand across all countries (excluding the UK). **Netherlands** leads all markets with the highest total quantity ordered. European markets dominate the top positions, confirming the store's strong presence in Europe. However, several non-European markets (e.g., Australia, Japan) show emerging demand worth monitoring for targeted expansion.

Rank	Country	Units Sold
1	Netherlands	200,361
2	EIRE	147,173
3	Germany	119,261
4	France	112,103
5	Australia	83,901
6	Sweden	36,083
7	Switzerland	30,629
8	Spain	27,940
9	Japan	26,016
10	Belgium	23,237
11	Norway	19,336
12	Portugal	16,258
13	Finland	10,704
14	Channel Islands	9,491
15	Denmark	8,235

Strategic Insight: The CEO should prioritise expansion into **Netherlands, EIRE, and Germany** where demand is both high and consistent. A phased expansion strategy — starting with warehouse or logistics partnerships in these regions — would reduce lead times and improve customer satisfaction, reinforcing demand growth.

Strategic Recommendations

1

Q4 Inventory & Marketing Planning

Revenue peaks sharply in Nov–Dec 2011. The business should build inventory reserves from August and launch targeted marketing campaigns in September to capture early holiday demand.

2

International Market Prioritisation

Netherlands, Netherlands, and Germany are the top non-UK revenue markets. Dedicated country-level marketing plans, localised websites, and currency support should be implemented to grow these markets further.

3

VIP Customer Retention Programme

The top 10 customers account for a significant portion of revenue. A formal CRM-driven loyalty programme with personalised outreach, account managers, and preferential pricing will protect this high-value revenue base.

4

Geographic Expansion Strategy

The demand analysis reveals strong appetite in European markets outside the UK. The CEO should consider a regional distribution centre in mainland Europe to reduce delivery times, lower fulfilment costs, and increase competitiveness in high-demand markets.

5

Revenue Diversification

Reliance on a handful of top customers and a seasonal Q4 spike represents business risk. Mid-year promotions (e.g., summer sales, spring campaigns) and broadening the customer base in emerging markets would smooth revenue curves and reduce concentration risk.

Data Source: Chen et al., 2012 — UCI ML Repository Online Retail Dataset. Analysis prepared April 2026. All figures in GBP (£).